



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

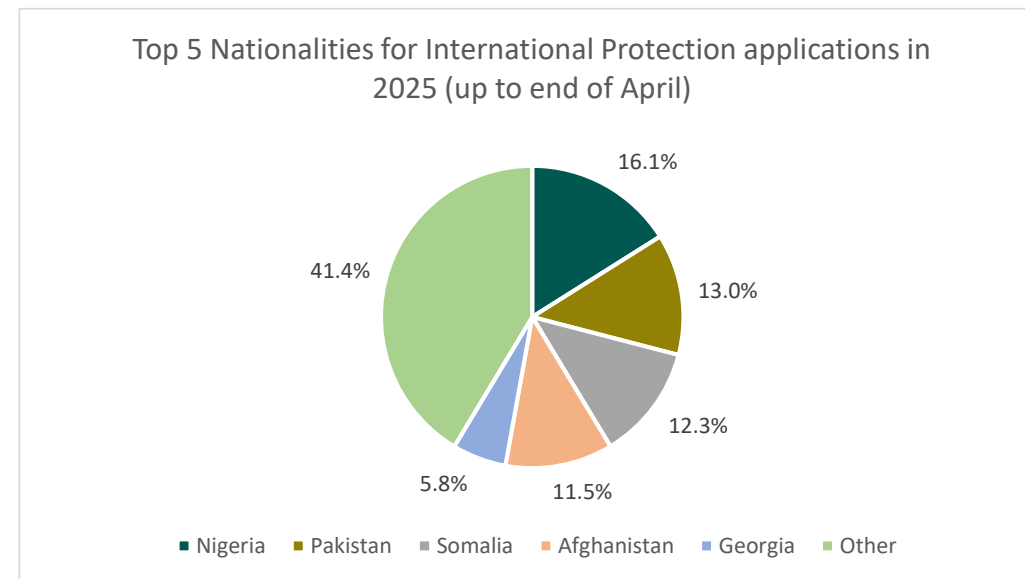
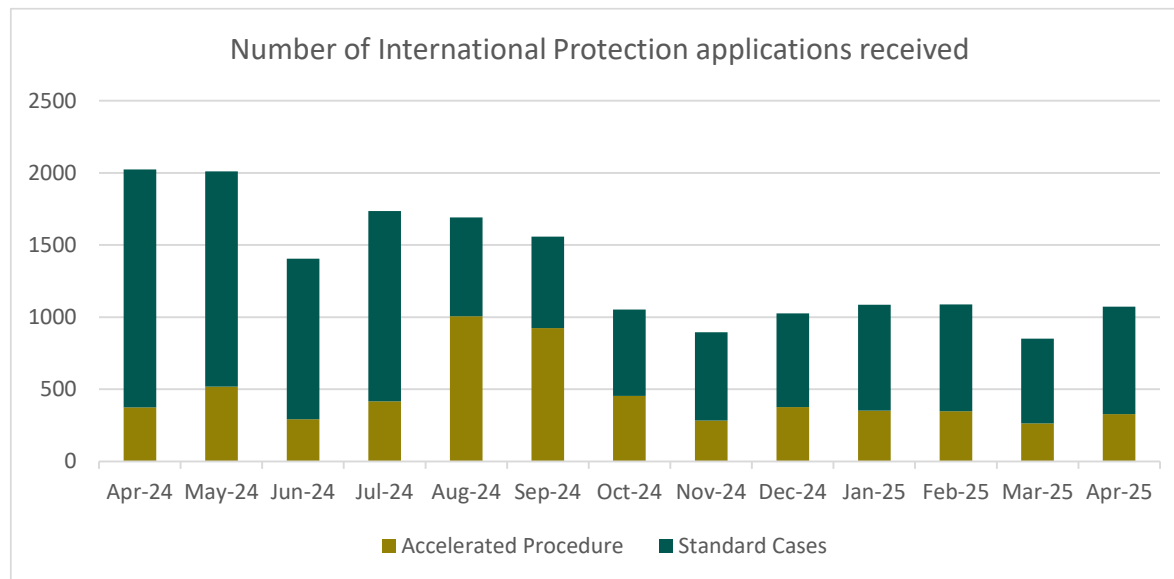
International Protection: April 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 06th May 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for April 2025:

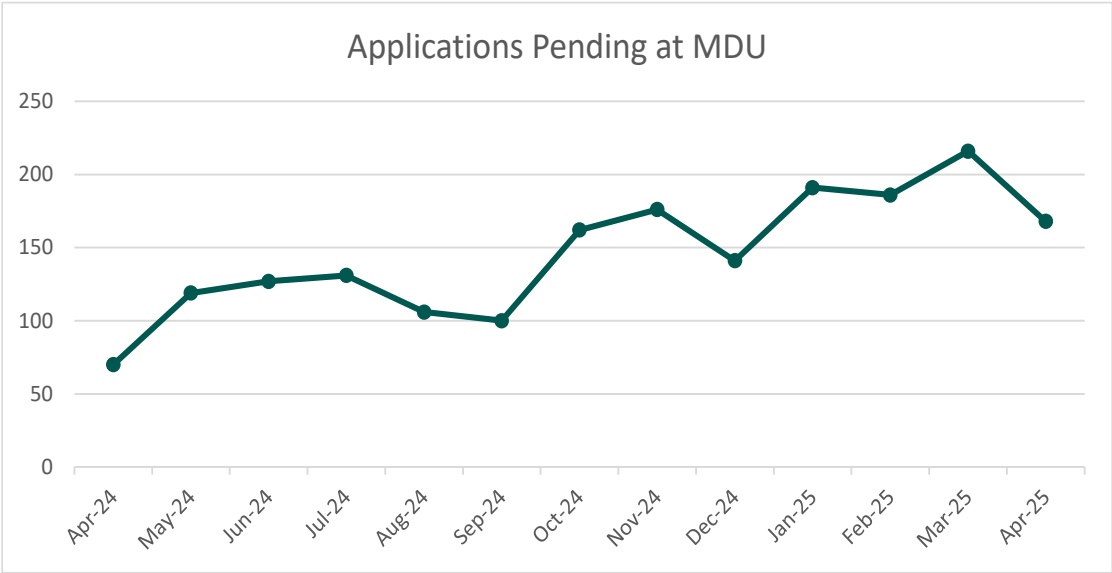
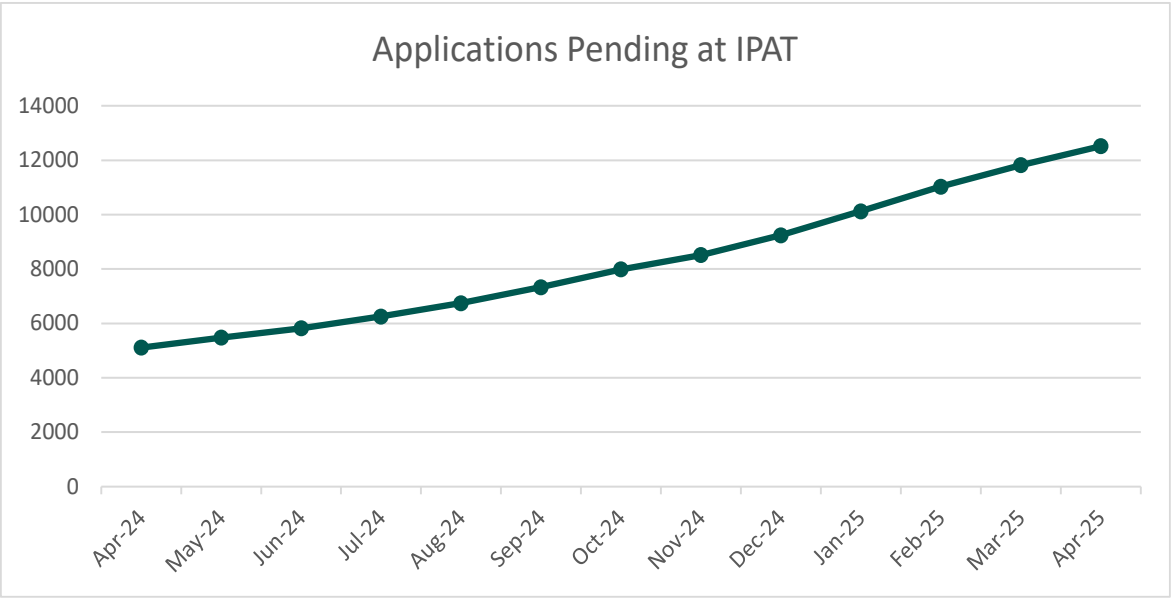
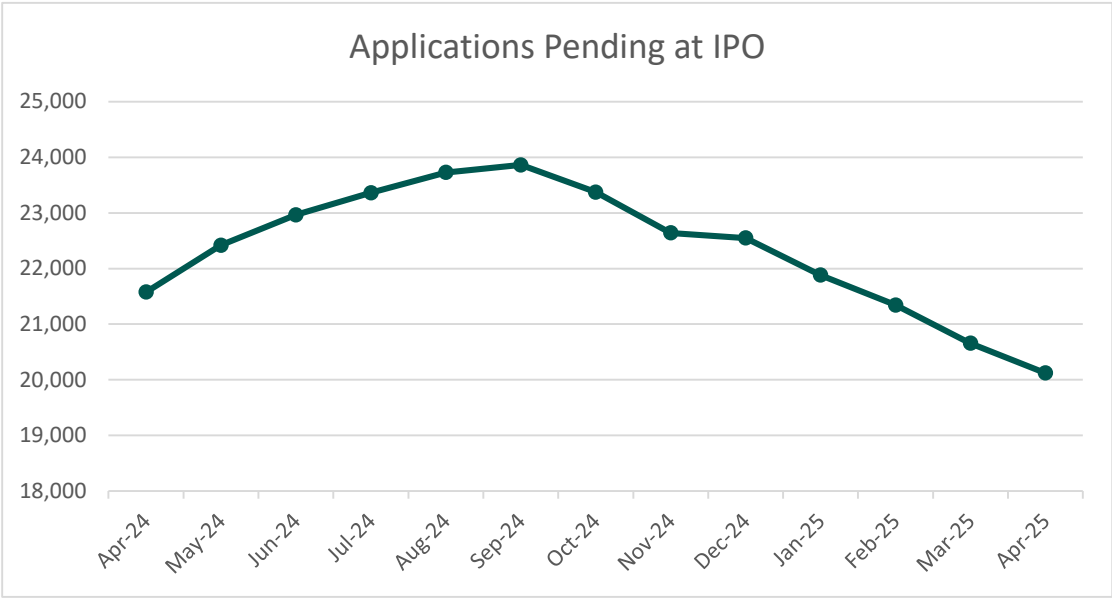
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has dropped significantly. In April 2025 there were 1,073 applications compared to 2,023 in April in 2024. For the year to date to April, the total number of applications has dropped from 7,184 down to 4,097, a reduction of 43%
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (658 applications), Pakistan (532), Somalia (504), Afghanistan (471) and Georgia (237)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,864. As of April this year, there were 20,122 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been an increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In April 2025, 1,579 cases were closed off compared to 1,152 in April 2024
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases is still trending slightly downwards. In April 2025, the median processing time to determination was 73 weeks (compared to 85 weeks in October 2024 and 82 weeks in January 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO has remained constant, 608 at the end of April 2025
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in April 2025 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 44.5% of decisions were refusals, 4.5% permission to remain, and 51% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



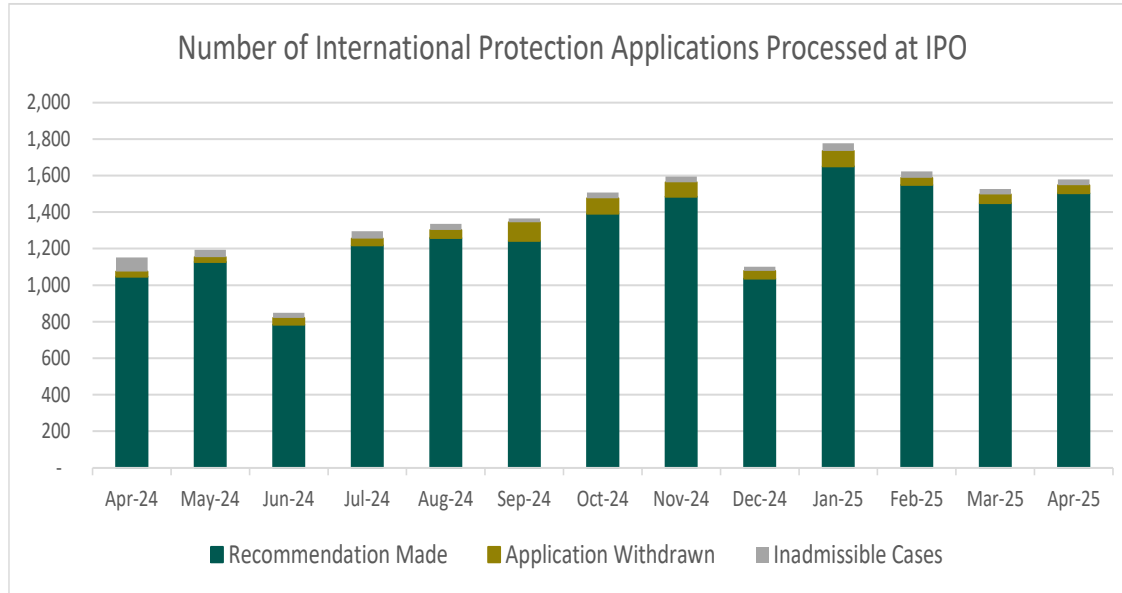
- In April there were 1,073 applications received for asylum. This is down from 2,023 last April
- The total number of applications in April 2025 that fell under accelerated procedure was 327 (which represents 30% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (658 applications), Pakistan (532), Somalia (504), Afghanistan (471) and Georgia (237)

Pending International Protection Applications

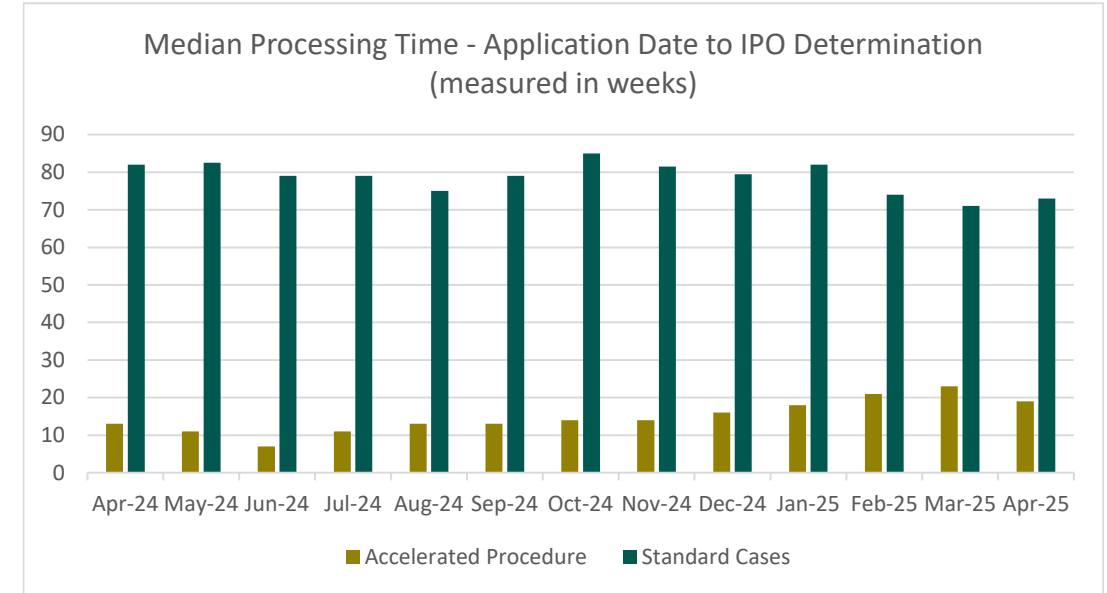


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 20,122. The numbers have begun to reduce since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In April 2025, there were 12,517 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of April 2025 is 168

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

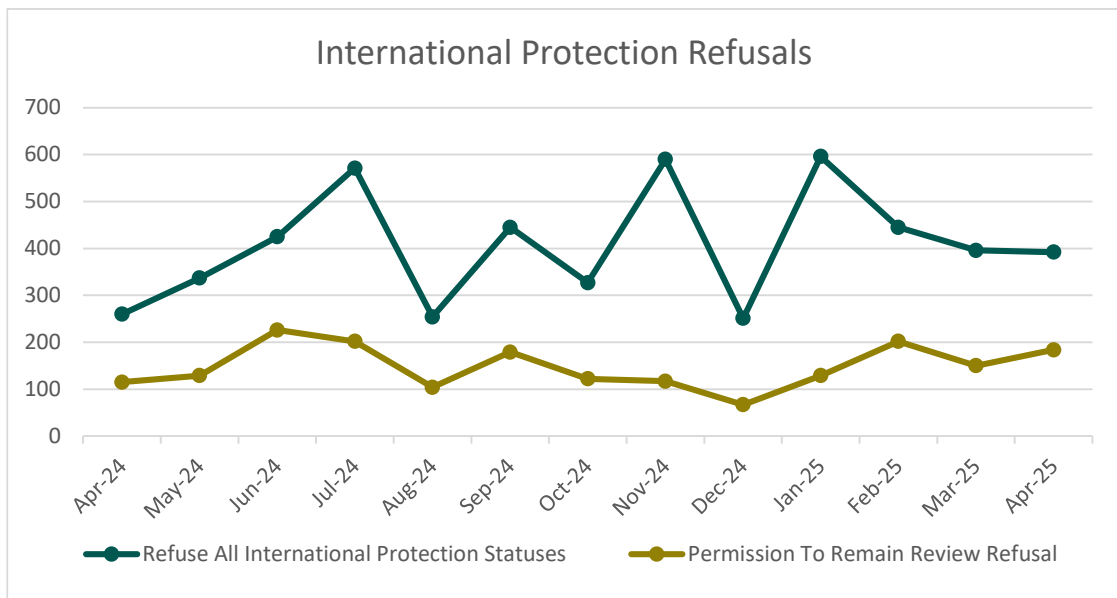
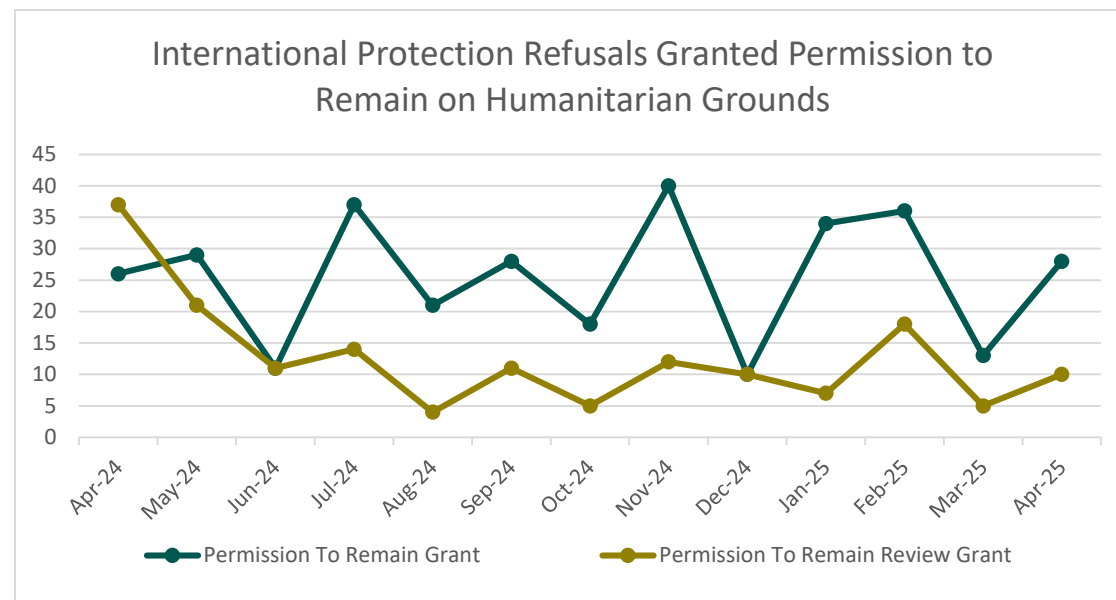
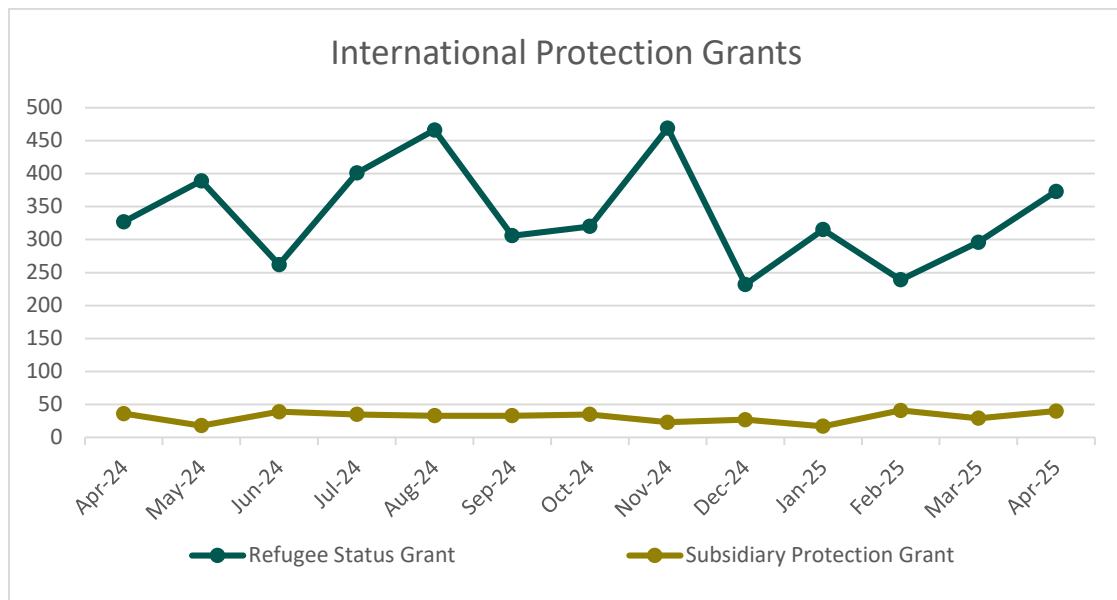


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In April 2025, 1,579 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,623 in February and up from 1,527 in March
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 6,506 (a 67.4% increase on 3,886 applications processed for 2024 YTD)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly decreasing since October 2024 for Standard Cases and has decreased for cases under the Accelerated Procedure between March and April 2025
- In April 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 73 weeks (down from 74 weeks for February and up from 71 weeks for March)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 19 weeks in April 2025, down from 21 weeks in February and 23 weeks in March

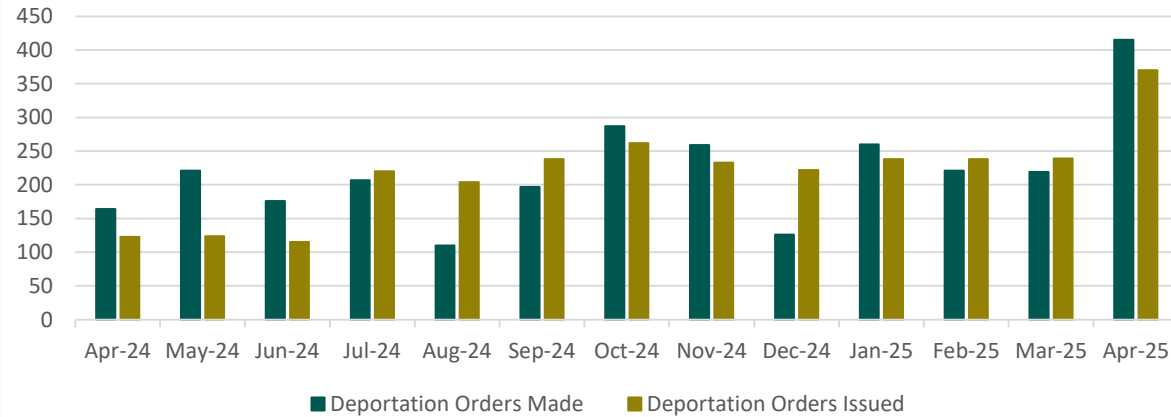
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In April 2025, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 373 were given refugee status grant and 40 subsidiary protection grant (413 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 28 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 10 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 392 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 184 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for April 2025, 44.5% of decisions were refusals, 4.5% permission to remain, and 51% were international protection grants

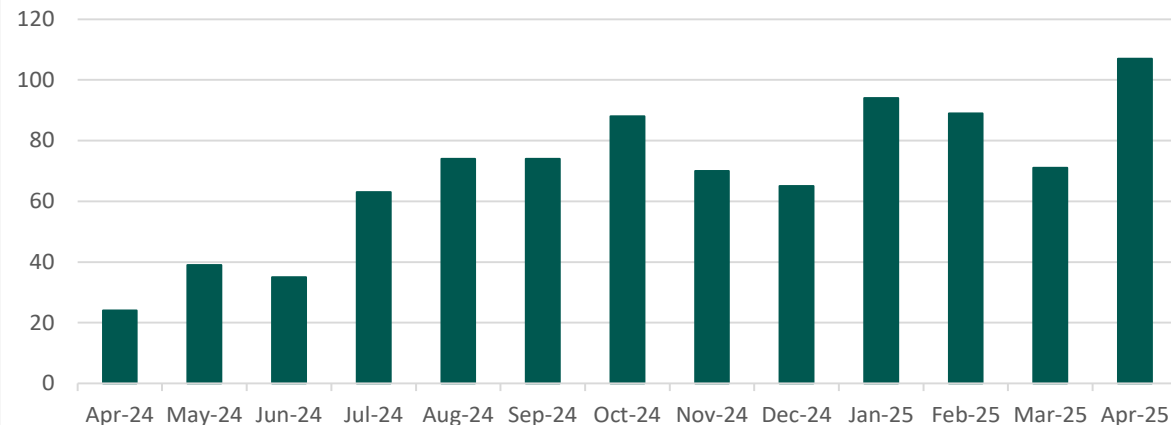
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

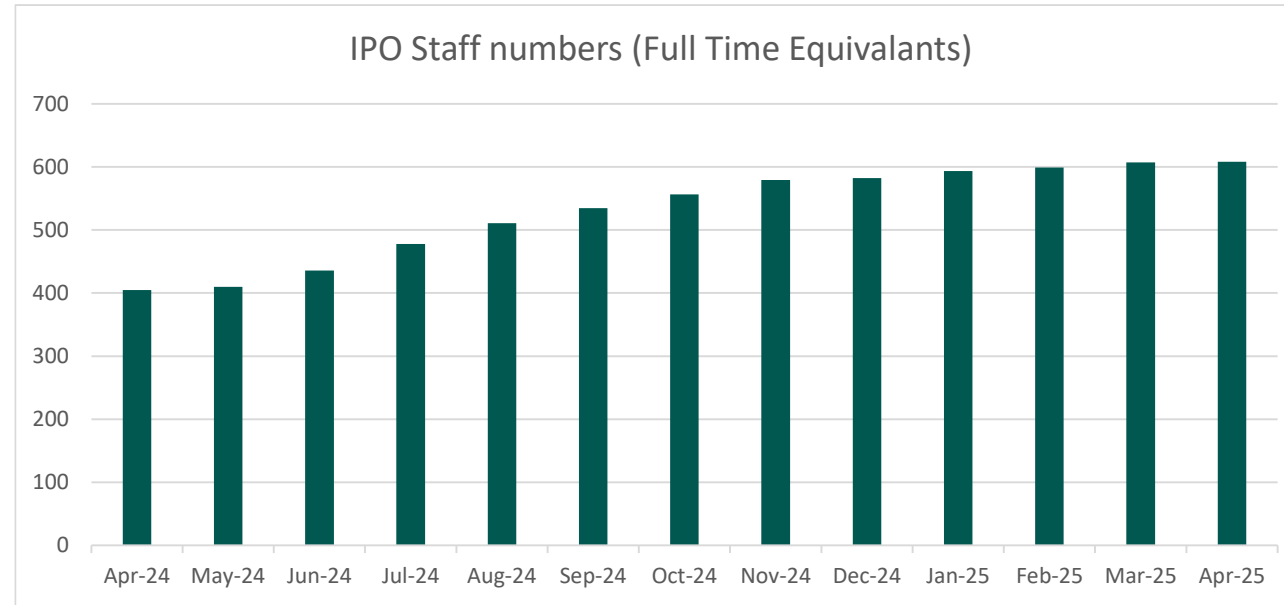


- For April 2025 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 415 and the number of deportation orders issued was 370. For March, the figures were 219 and 239, and for February, it was 221 and 238, respectively
- For April 2025 the number of removals was 107

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In April 2024 there were 405 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 556 in October 2024 and 593 in January 2025
- At the end of April 2025, the IPO had 608 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

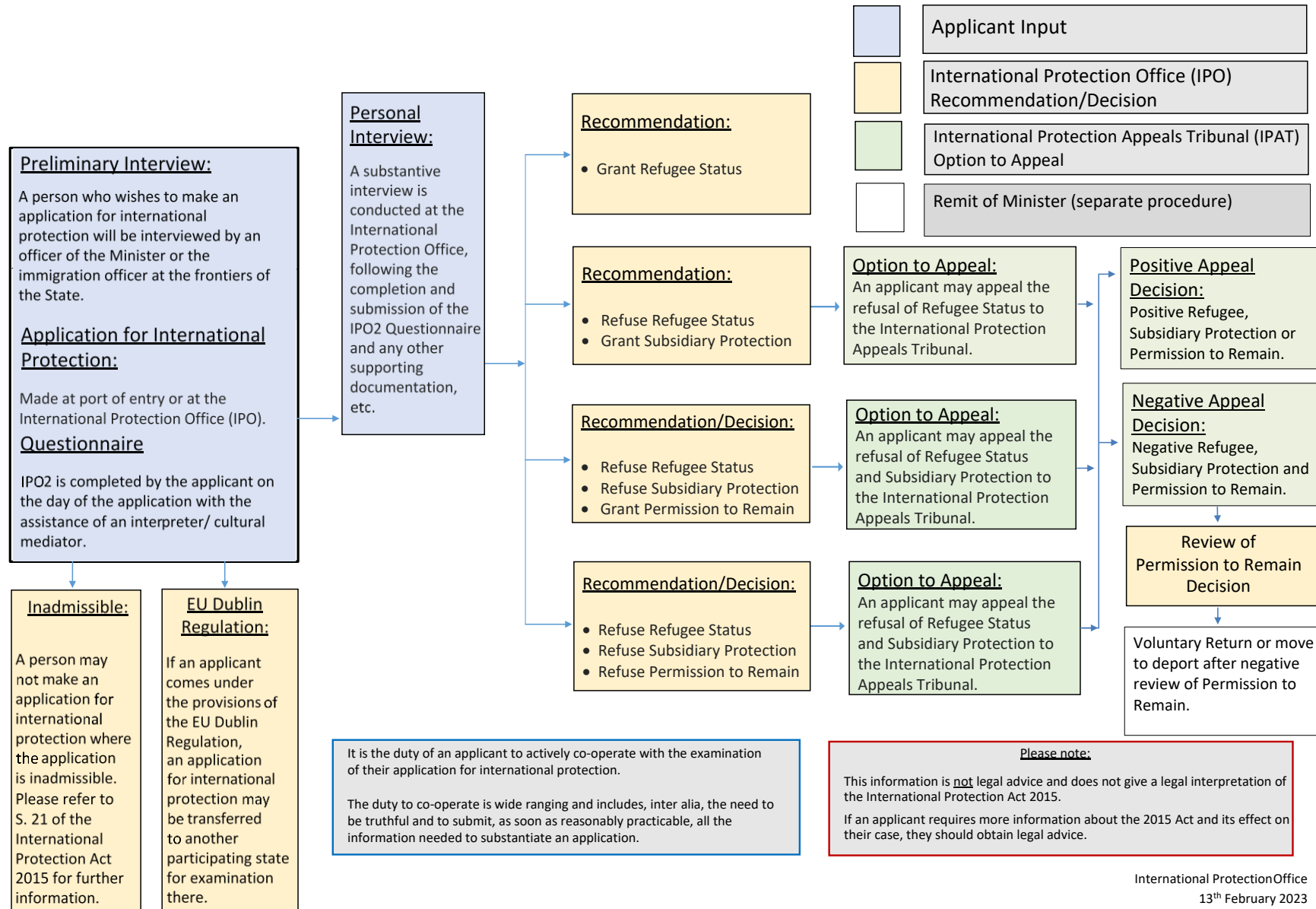
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
Accelerated Procedure	374	518	292	417	1005	923	453	282	377	351	347	264	327
Standard Cases	1649	1492	1112	1318	687	635	599	614	648	734	742	586	746

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	658	16.1%
Pakistan	532	13.0%
Somalia	504	12.3%
Afghanistan	471	11.5%
Georgia	237	5.8%
Other	1695	41.4%
Total	4097	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
IP Pending	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727	23,863	23,373	22,641	22,548	21,882	21,343	20,655	20,122

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
IPAT Pending	5,110	5,478	5,821	6,257	6,748	7,331	7,990	8,513	9,243	10,125	11,031	11,819	12,517

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
MDU Pending	70	119	127	131	106	100	162	176	141	191	186	216	168

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
Recommendation Made	1,047	1,128	784	1,219	1,259	1,243	1,392	1,484	1,036	1,651	1,550	1,449	1,504
Application Withdrawn	28	25	36	36	44	101	83	80	43	84	38	47	43
Inadmissible Cases	77	40	29	40	32	21	33	30	22	42	35	31	32

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
Accelerated Procedure	13	11	7	11	13	13	14	14	16	18	21	23	19
Standard Cases	82	82.5	79	79	75	79	85	81.5	79.5	82	74	71	73

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
Refugee Status Grant	327	389	262	401	466	306	320	469	232	315	239	296	373
Subsidiary Protection Grant	36	18	39	35	33	33	35	23	27	17	41	29	40
Permission To Remain Grant	26	29	11	37	21	28	18	40	10	34	36	13	28
Permission To Remain Review Grant	37	21	11	14	4	11	5	12	10	7	18	5	10

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	260	337	425	571	254	445	327	590	251	596	445	396	392
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	115	129	226	202	104	179	122	117	67	129	202	150	184

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
Deportation Orders Made	164	221	176	207	110	197	287	259	126	260	221	219	415
Deportation Orders Issued	123	124	115	220	204	238	262	233	222	238	238	239	370

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
Enforcements/Returns*	24	39	35	63	74	74	88	70	65	94	89	71	107

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25
IPO Staffing Level	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3	556.3	579.1	582.1	593.4	598.8	607	608